

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-06-17

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 15:50-58

50 Flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God; nor does corruption inherit incorruption.

51 We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed—

52 In a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound, and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed.

53 For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and this mortal must put on immortality.

54 So when this corruptible has put on incorruption, and this mortal has put on immortality, then shall be brought to pass the saying that is written: "Death is swallowed up in victory."

55 "O Death, where is your sting? O Hades, where is your victory?"

56 The sting of death is sin, and the strength of sin is the law.

57 But thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ.

58 Therefore, my beloved brethren, be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, knowing that your labor is not in vain in the Lord.

II. Key Summary

- Paul states that flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God, and the corruptible body must be changed into an incorruptible one.
 - Paul describes this change happening at the last trumpet, in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, when the dead will be raised incorruptible.
 - Paul quotes the scripture that death will be "swallowed up in victory," and on that basis urges believers to be steadfast and unmovable, always abounding in the Lord's work, knowing their labor is not in vain.
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III. Passage Analysis

Death Has Already Been Defeated — It's No Longer the End

"A resurrected body is not a resuscitated corpse. It is a new order of life that will never die again. Death is defeated by resurrection." [1]

Paul almost taunts death here: "O Death, where is your sting?" To most people, death is the biggest, final threat there is. But Paul says that because Jesus rose from the dead, death's sting has already been pulled out. It still looks terrifying, but it's actually a toothless old lion.

Your Effort Right Now Is Not Wasted

"Because we know death is defeated and we have an eternal, resurrected destiny with Jesus Christ, we should stand firm and unshakable all the more for Him right now... right now counts forever." [2]

Paul isn't saying "since we'll be resurrected anyway, nothing we do now matters." It's the opposite: precisely because the ending is already secure, every step you take now matters more. Whether anyone notices or says thank you, the effort you put into doing what's right counts with God.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever worked really hard at something, but it felt pointless or invisible, and you started wanting to quit?

Paul says "your labor is not in vain in the Lord" — his point is that everything you do counts with God, even if it never gets wasted.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-15/>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-15/>